

● HARD

● STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

● ANSWER KEY

Standard English Conventions

07

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**C**

C. linguist Diane Massam

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed to set off the proper noun "Diane Massam" from the title that describes Massam, "linguist." Because "Diane Massam" is essential information identifying the "linguist," no punctuation is necessary.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun "Diane Massam." Setting the linguist's name off with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn't the case. Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed.

Q2**A**

A. electrograms show that while responding to hypothetical match scenarios, the most highly skilled soccer players have

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-modifier placement. This choice makes the noun "electrograms" the subject of the sentence and places it immediately after the modifying phrase "recordings of electrical activity in the brain." In doing so, this choice clearly establishes that electrograms—and not other nouns or noun phrases in the sentence—are recordings of electrical activity in the brain.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "the most highly skilled soccer players" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that the players are recordings of electrical activity in the brain. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "responses to hypothetical match scenarios" immediately after the modifying phrase illogically suggests that these responses are recordings of electrical activity in the brain. Choice D is incorrect because it results in a dangling modifier. The placement of the noun phrase "hypothetical match scenario responses" immediately after the opening phrase illogically suggests that these responses are recordings of electrical activity in the brain.

Q3

C

C. *Gingerbread*

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is punctuation between a subject and a verb. When, as in this case, a subject (“her 2019 novel *Gingerbread*”) is immediately followed by a verb (“offers”), no punctuation is needed.

Choice A is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the subject and the verb.

Q4

C

C. highly prized

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms in a sentence. The nonfinite past participle phrase “highly prized” is correctly used to form a supplementary element that modifies the main clause “this...artistry,” describing memorable features of Brass Era automotive design.

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Using the finite present tense verb phrase “are highly prized” creates a second main clause in the sentence, and two main clauses can’t be joined in this way with only a comma after “artistry.” Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Using the finite past perfect tense verb phrase “had been highly prized” creates a second main clause in the sentence, and two main clauses can’t be joined in this way with only a comma after “artistry.” Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Using the finite past tense verb phrase “were highly prized” creates a second main clause in the sentence, and two main clauses can’t be joined in this way with only a comma after “artistry.”

Q5

D

D. 1929, for one. The

Choice D is the best answer. The conventions being tested are punctuation use between sentences and the punctuation of a supplementary element. This choice correctly uses a period to mark the boundary between one sentence ("During...one") and another ("The *Katzenbach*...event") and uses a comma to separate the supplementary phrase "for one" from the preceding main clause. Further, placing the period after "for one" correctly indicates that the information in the preceding main clause ("the founding...1929") is the first example provided of a pivotal event in the Latino rights movement.

Choice A is incorrect because placing the period after "1929" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause (describing the *Katzenbach v. Morgan* court decision) is the first example provided of a pivotal event in the Latino rights movement; rather, it's a second example. Choice B is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Choice C is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses. Moreover, it fails to use appropriate punctuation to separate the supplementary element "for one" from the preceding main clause.

Q6

D

D. looking

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. The nonfinite present participle verb "looking" is correctly used to form a subordinate clause that describes the intent behind how L'Engle begins her novel.

Choice A is incorrect because the finite past tense verb "looked" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause. Choice B is incorrect because the finite present tense verb "looks" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause. Choice C is incorrect because the finite present progressive tense verb "is looking" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause.

Q7**B**

B. speculative, though;

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation in a sentence. This choice correctly uses a comma to separate the supplementary adverb "though" from the preceding main clause ("Such interpretations are ultimately speculative") and uses a semicolon to join the next main clause ("the object's...makeup") to the rest of the sentence. Further, placing the semicolon after "though" indicates that the information in the preceding main clause (interpretations of an outer solar system object's composition based on its color are ultimately speculative) is a qualification of the information in the previous sentence (the composition of an outer solar system object is suggested by its color).

Choice A is incorrect because it fails to mark the boundary between the two main clauses with appropriate punctuation. Choice C is incorrect because placing the semicolon after "speculative" illogically indicates that the information in the next main clause ("the object's...makeup") is a qualification of the information in the previous clause ("Such...speculative"). Choice D is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. Commas can't be used in this way to punctuate a supplementary word or phrase between two main clauses.

Q8**A**

A. fascinate

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The plural verb "fascinate" agrees in number with the plural subject "musings."

Choice B is incorrect because the singular verb "has fascinated" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "musings." Choice C is incorrect because the singular verb "fascinates" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "musings." Choice D is incorrect because the singular verb "is fascinating" doesn't agree in number with the plural subject "musings."

Q9**D**

D. music: the flute. A

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation within and between sentences. In this choice, the colon correctly introduces the name of the instrument (the flute) that novel audio technologies allowed to be added to jazz and swing. In addition, the period is used to correctly mark the boundary between one sentence ("In...flute") and another ("A relatively...greats").

Choice A is incorrect because it results in a comma splice. A comma can't be used in this way to join two main clauses ("In...quiet instrument" and "its...greats"). Choice B is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form a sentence in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing sentence. Choice C is incorrect. In standard English, it's unconventional to form an independent clause in this way with two uncoordinated subjects ("the flute" and "its full range of sound"), and the lack of a clear main subject results in an awkwardly constructed and confusing clause.

Q10**D**

D. will be

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is finite and nonfinite verb forms within a sentence. Relative clauses, such as the one beginning with "that," require a finite verb, a verb that can function as the main verb of a clause. This choice correctly supplies the clause with the finite future tense verb "will be."

Choice A is incorrect because the nonfinite participle "being" doesn't supply the clause with a finite verb. Choice B is incorrect because the nonfinite to-infinitive "to be" doesn't supply the clause with a finite verb. Choice C is incorrect because the nonfinite to-infinitive "to have been" doesn't supply the clause with a finite verb.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

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